



Knowledge Check & Practical Assessment

Programme: Zimbabwe Real Estate Foundations | Module: Foundations of Real Estate | Study time: 40 min

Lesson Overview

This assessment evaluates the learner's understanding and practical application of the core principles covered in Chapter 1 of the HouseLink Zimbabwe Real Estate Academy. Learners will be tested on the role and responsibilities of an estate agent, professional conduct, client relationships, property verification, ownership and authority, documentation, trust, fraud awareness, scam prevention and professional decision-making. The assessment combines knowledge questions with realistic Zimbabwean property scenarios designed to test whether the learner can apply professional judgement rather than simply recall information.

Key Takeaways

■	Demonstrate understanding of the role and responsibilities of an estate agent
■	Explain the difference between ownership, possession, and authority
■	Apply verification principles to realistic property scenarios
■	Identify red flags in suspicious property transactions
■	Audit property listings for unsupported claims and professional compliance
■	Respond professionally to client frustration during verification processes
■	Create comprehensive property intake checklists
■	Handle complex ownership situations involving deceased estates and family disputes
■	Apply scam prevention principles to various fraudulent scenarios
■	Recognize professional boundaries and when to seek specialist assistance
■	Develop complete professional workflows from first contact to transaction completion
■	Apply the HouseLink verification and scam prevention frameworks systematically
■	Demonstrate professional judgement in complex real-world situations
■	Identify knowledge gaps for continued professional development
■	Prepare for progression to intermediate-level training

Learning Objectives

Use this checklist to confirm you can apply this lesson professionally:

Learning objective	Self-check
Demonstrate understanding of the role and responsibilities of an estate agent	☐ Confident ☐ Practising ☐ Review
Explain the difference between ownership, possession, and authority	☐ Confident ☐ Practising ☐ Review
Apply verification principles to realistic property scenarios	☐ Confident ☐ Practising ☐ Review
Identify red flags in suspicious property transactions	☐ Confident ☐ Practising ☐ Review
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Apply scam prevention principles to various fraudulent scenarios	☐ Confident ☐ Practising ☐ Review
Recognize professional boundaries and when to seek specialist assistance	☐ Confident ☐ Practising ☐ Review
Develop complete professional workflows from first contact to transaction completion	☐ Confident ☐ Practising ☐ Review
Apply the HouseLink verification and scam prevention frameworks systematically	☐ Confident ☐ Practising ☐ Review
Demonstrate professional judgement in complex real-world situations	☐ Confident ☐ Practising ☐ Review
Identify knowledge gaps for continued professional development	☐ Confident ☐ Practising ☐ Review
Prepare for progression to intermediate-level training	☐ Confident ☐ Practising ☐ Review

Lesson Guide

In-depth notes for Knowledge Check & Practical Assessment - study, annotate, and revisit before client meetings.

Chapter 1 Knowledge Check & Practical Assessment

Congratulations on reaching the final lesson of Chapter 1.

You have now covered the foundations of professional real estate practice, including the role of an estate agent, professional conduct, client relationships, property verification, ownership and authority, documentation, trust and scam prevention.

This final assessment is designed to test whether you can apply what you have learned.

Being a professional estate agent is not simply about knowing definitions. In the real world, you will encounter situations where clients are putting pressure on you, information is incomplete, documents may be unclear, different people may make conflicting claims and buyers or sellers may want you to move faster than your verification process allows.

Your responsibility is to remain professional, identify what you know, identify what you do not know, verify important information and know when a matter must be referred to the appropriate professional.

PART 1 — CORE KNOWLEDGE

Question 1

In your own words, explain the role of a professional estate agent.

Your answer should explain more than simply “selling houses.” Consider the agent’s role in connecting parties, communicating information, managing the transaction process, protecting clients and acting professionally.

Question 2

Explain the difference between:

Ownership Possession Authority

Why is it important for an estate agent to understand the difference?

Question 3

Why should an agent not automatically assume that the person occupying a property is the owner or has authority to sell it?

Question 4

Why is it dangerous to advertise an unverified claim such as:

“Approved development site.”

when the relevant approval has not been established?

Question 5

List at least five important pieces of information that an estate agent may need to verify before making material representations about a property.

Question 6

Explain the difference between an owner’s statement and independently verified information.

Question 7

Why should an estate agent maintain a proper property file?

Question 8

Why does professional trust not mean blindly believing everything a client tells you?

Question 9

What should an estate agent do when faced with a complicated ownership dispute?

Question 10

Explain the HouseLink verification process:

IDENTIFY → DOCUMENT → COMPARE → VERIFY → RECORD → REFER → MARKET

Explain what each stage means in practical terms.

PART 2 — PROFESSIONAL DECISION-MAKING

For each situation below, explain what you would do as a professional HouseLink agent and why.

Scenario 1

A homeowner contacts you and provides identification and relevant property documentation. The information appears consistent and the client is willing to complete the normal agency process.

Would you proceed? Explain.

Scenario 2

A man tells you:

“I am the owner’s brother. She is overseas, so I am selling the house for her.”

He has the keys but cannot provide evidence of his authority to act for the owner.

What would you do?

Scenario 3

A seller tells you:

“This property has council approval for 20 apartments.”

When you ask for supporting documentation, the seller says:

“Don’t worry. The approval is basically guaranteed.”

How should you handle the claim?

Scenario 4

A buyer sends you a screenshot showing that USD 15,000 has supposedly been paid and asks you to immediately confirm the payment to the seller.

What should you do?

Scenario 5

Two different people contact you claiming they have authority over the same property. Each person tells you not to listen to the other.

What should you do?

Scenario 6

A seller asks you:

“Please don't tell buyers about the restriction on the property. If they know about it, they won't buy.”

How should a professional agent respond?

PART 3 — RED FLAG IDENTIFICATION

Read this situation carefully.

A person contacts HouseLink through WhatsApp claiming to own a property in Harare worth USD 500,000.

They want to sell it immediately for USD 250,000.

They say they are currently outside Zimbabwe.

They send photographs of the property and a photograph of what appears to be a title document.

They tell you:

“My cousin has the keys. He will show buyers the property. Don't worry about the paperwork; I will send everything later.”

The cousin then contacts you and says:

“I am handling everything for the owner. The buyer must pay the deposit directly to me because the owner is outside the country.”

The cousin also asks you to send the buyer copies of the owner's personal documents.

Identify at least 10 potential red flags in this situation.

For every red flag, explain why it matters.

PART 4 — PROPERTY LISTING AUDIT

Consider this advertisement:

URGENT SALE!

PRIME BORROWDALE DEVELOPMENT PROPERTY — FULLY APPROVED!

5,000sqm commercial property.

Approved for 30 luxury apartments.

Guaranteed USD 1 million return.

Owner is desperate and selling for only USD 250,000.

Title deeds available.

Pay USD 10,000 today to secure the property.

Contact the owner directly for payment.

Your task is to identify every statement or part of the advertisement that requires verification, clarification or removal.

Then rewrite the advertisement so that it is professional and does not make unsupported claims.

PART 5 — CLIENT COMMUNICATION

A seller becomes frustrated during the verification process.

They say:

"Why are you asking me for all these documents? I've lived in this house for 20 years. If you don't trust me, I'll find another agent."

Write the response you would send as a professional HouseLink agent.

Your response should:

Remain respectful. Protect the relationship. Explain why verification is necessary. Not accuse the seller of dishonesty. Make it clear that the process protects everyone involved. PART 6 — PRACTICAL PROPERTY INTAKE

You have received a new property listing.

Create a practical property intake checklist containing at least 25 questions or checks you would complete before marketing the property.

Your checklist should consider:

Seller identity. Seller authority. Ownership. Property identification. Property size. Relevant documentation. Occupation. Tenants. Development claims. Planning matters. Restrictions. Servitudes. Outstanding obligations. Property condition. Marketing claims. Property photographs. Asking price. Potential red flags. Specialist referrals. Record keeping. PART 7 — ZIMBABWE PROPERTY CASE STUDY

You are working with a property owner in Harare.

The person tells you:

"This property belonged to my mother. She passed away last year. I am the only son, so the family agreed that I should sell it."

The person provides:

A copy of the deceased person's identification document. An old title document. A family agreement signed by several relatives. A utility bill in the person's name. Photographs of the property.

The person wants HouseLink to advertise the property for USD 300,000.

They tell you:

"Don't involve lawyers. The family has already agreed."

Later, another family member contacts you and says:

"Do not sell that property. There is an estate dispute."

Write a professional step-by-step action plan explaining what you would do.

Your answer should demonstrate:

Professional judgement. Verification. Confidentiality. Risk management. Understanding of authority. Appropriate referral. PART 8 — SCAM PREVENTION

Explain how you would respond to each of the following:

- A. A buyer sends a fake-looking proof of payment.
- B. Someone copies a HouseLink property listing and advertises it using their own phone number.
- C. A person claims to represent the owner but cannot establish their authority.
- D. A buyer asks for the seller's identification documents before even viewing the property.

E. A seller demands that you publish a property immediately without completing verification.

For each situation, explain what action you would take and why.

PART 9 — PROFESSIONAL BOUNDARIES

Explain when an estate agent should seek assistance from an appropriate specialist.

Give a practical example involving each of the following:

Legal practitioner or conveyancing professional. Planning professional or relevant authority. Registered valuer. Surveyor. Building or technical professional.

Explain why knowing when to refer a matter is itself a professional skill.

PART 10 — FINAL PROFESSIONAL CHALLENGE

You receive a new property listing tomorrow.

You need to decide whether HouseLink should accept and market the property.

Write a complete professional workflow showing what you would do from:

First Contact → Client Onboarding → Property Verification → Document Review → Red Flag Assessment → Specialist Referral → Listing Preparation → Marketing → Buyer Enquiry → Viewing → Offer → Transaction Handover.

For every stage, explain:

What you would do. What you would verify. What you would document. What could cause you to pause. When you would refer the matter. FINAL REFLECTION

Complete this sentence in your own words:

“A professional estate agent is not simply someone who sells property. A professional estate agent is someone who...”

Your answer should reflect what you have learned throughout Chapter 1.

CHAPTER 1 FINAL PRINCIPLE

Professional real estate is not simply about closing deals.

It is about managing relationships, information, expectations and risk while helping legitimate parties move toward legitimate property transactions.

Your reputation is built through every interaction.

Every listing you accept represents your professional judgement.

Every statement you make represents your credibility.

Every document you handle carries responsibility.

Every client interaction contributes to the reputation of both you and the agency.

Remember:

Do not guess where you can verify.

Do not promise what you cannot establish.

Do not ignore a red flag because a commission is attractive.

Do not operate outside your professional competence.

Do not allow pressure to replace process.

And most importantly:

Be the agent clients can trust because your professionalism is supported by a process they can see.

Apply in the Field

■	Practise: Demonstrate understanding of the role and responsibilities of an estate agent
■	Practise: Explain the difference between ownership, possession, and authority
■	Practise: Apply verification principles to realistic property scenarios
■	Practise: Identify red flags in suspicious property transactions

Reflection Questions

1. How will you apply “Demonstrate understanding of the role and responsibilities of an estate agent” in your next client conversation or property visit?
2. What is one habit you will change this week based on “Knowledge Check & Practical Assessment”?
3. Which part of this lesson needs more practice before you move on — and how will you get it?

Professional Tip

The best HouseLink agents translate training into consistent field habits. Read this note, use the linked forms, then practise one action before your next lesson.

HouseLink Zimbabwe Agent Academy — confidential lesson notes for enrolled learners. Apply this guidance professionally and in line with HouseLink standards.